

Write to the Editor

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had read about it in one of your competitor's mag. They have provided an article on this in 2005.

Second thing: I would like to see a *Fast Track to Linux*—right from installing any version of Linux like Fedora Core to installing software on it. Also, a *Fast Track* to character animation using any free 3D modelling software like Blender or Realsoft 3D or Lightwave 3D etc.

The cover design is always great, the artwork like drawings, etc need to be praised. The CD and DVD contents are very satisfying, and let me tell you, I have not purchased any software recently because I now use the freeware you give on your media and I don't feel purchasing any pirated stuff now.

Viplaw

Your requests merit very different answers, Viplaw. First, about a *Fast Track* to 3D animation—using various software—and such, they are indeed in the pipeline. We're trying to cover as many popular topics as possible. But regarding articles that would cater to, say, civil engineers, it is purely a matter of demand—and we'll have to see what works for us. I'm not dismissing it, but we will have to take the time to look into it.

Thanks for writing in.

— Executive Editor

DVDs And DirectX

I am an avid reader of computer magazines and have been buying *Digit* issues on and off. Till date I have never faced a problem with the CDs/DVDs supplied with the issue, but as they say, "There's always a first time," and October's issue of *Digit* was my first introduction with a malfunctioning DVD. I bought this issue from a vendor in Chittaranjan Park, New Delhi. May I request you to please send me a replacement for the DVD of the issue.

The magazine is informative, but in general, the topics that you cover tend to be recurring—which is a bit disappointing. For example, graphics cards is a topic which one gets to see in the computer magazines often. The introduction of DirectX 10 has not brought about a huge change in the gaming world. This may be a one-sided view, but I do feel that this topic could have been delayed.

It would be great if you could add the full version of games as you done with this issue. I came across SKOAR!, which does that, and the only problem is that all the good games are in

multiplayer format. In India the Internet is still costly! If one can add good single-player games, I am sure it will add to your readership base.

Sudipta Chakravorty
New Delhi

Dear Sudipta,

I'm glad you've written in, but our customer care desk does take care of defective DVD problems—which, as you're aware, are bound to happen. In any case, I'll personally ensure your DVD is replaced.

Regarding DX10, well, some people might say quite the opposite—that that's where gaming is moving to, and that we therefore shouldn't be stuck on DX9! Finally, regarding full versions of single-player games, I must tell you that sadly, getting licenses for these is a very expensive affair—we'd have to bump up the magazine price hugely to compensate.

— Executive Editor

Take Thirteen

I am a regular reader of *Digit*. I read the article "Take Ten" in the October 2007 issue of *Digit*. The article was quite informative although the author missed out on some of the best free cross-platform games like Wolfenstein: *Enemy Territory*, *Urban Terror 4.0*, and *America's Army*. Please have a look at this excellent thread regarding these free games: <http://forums.erodov.com/showthread.php?t=450>

I hope this information is passed onto the author of the article.

Raman

Hi Raman,

Well, we had only ten games to play with (pun not intended), so some games would have to be missed out... in any case, I've passed on your link to the writer. I've also published this here for our readers' benefit.

— Executive Editor

The Fast Track To Fast Track

I would like to own a copy of each of your editions of *Fast Track* published till date. If it's possible, do inform me regarding the procedure

Bhavya Jain

Hi Bhavya,

You can get all the *Fast Track* issues in PDF format every year off our DVD. The next one is due December 2007. Don't miss it!

— Executive Editor

"Inevitable"?

I am an ardent reader of your magazine, and am surprised that I rarely read letters from readers acknowledging your brilliant editorials. I am being very frank when I say that the article I look forward to reading the most is your editorial. I must compliment you on them, as every time I find them awe-inspiring and thought provoking.

I'd like to share with you my thoughts on the Linux vs. Microsoft war. The Mint distro you provided on last month's CD is what set off a chain of thoughts in my mind. As I used Mint, I was very pleasantly surprised by its rock-solid stability, beautiful interface and out of the box usability. It struck me that Linux was improving at an extremely fast rate. I say improving and not progressing because progress can be good or bad, but in the case of Linux, every distro is undoubtedly better than the other.

Now switching over to Microsoft for a bit, we all have to accept that Vista was very much below everyone's expectations. Perhaps we all expected too much, perhaps not. But the ground reality is the fact that it has been a whole nine months since the launch of Vista, and look around, no it's not catching up. Vista took Microsoft over five years to develop, and they released an OS that did not have enough features to make most people see reason enough to upgrade. On the other hand, we have so many new distros of Linux being launched every month and each and everyone with brand new, must have features. Linux is clearly poised to take the lead.

But why just poised? Why isn't it? There is one very simple, very obvious reason. Software. If you want to play your favourite game without hiccups, "stick to Windows" is what even seasoned Linux gurus will tell you. Same for your favourite anti-virus, spyware scanner or even your drivers. But things are indeed changing. Slowly, Companies are finding it harder and harder to ignore the growing Linux user base.

At the end of the day, you and me both know that eventually everyone is going to upgrade to Vista. But the big question is, will they do the same when Microsoft releases its next OS? Or will they double-click on the little install icon in Ubuntu?

Omi

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH